



SABLE HARBOR ADVISORY — TALENT, MOBILITY AND CARRY

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1. Talent thesis

Advisory is built around scarce judgment, operating experience, professional mastery and the ability to transfer capability. It does not require a classic consulting pedigree and does not use a pyramid as its primary production architecture.

The firm should be able to hire:

- people who have spent decades operating difficult physical systems;
- people who have built unusual technical or institutional capability;
- former J2 professionals who have completed qualifying service;
- external specialists with deep domain credibility;
- high-slope early-career people worth apprenticing into judgment rather than into repetitive production work.

The professional hierarchy should allow a master practitioner to out-earn a manager without acquiring line authority.

2. Recruiting regimes

2.1 External market

Advisory may recruit aggressively from the external market. It may approach people directly, recruit by name, use scouts, hire unconventional profiles and pay a premium for unusual professional depth.

External hires may receive strong salary, bonus, profit participation, retention awards and other approved compensation. Advisory carry, however, is reserved to qualifying former J2 professionals.

2.2 Sable Harbor operating business lines

Advisory may actively recruit from Sable Harbor operating lines, including by name.

The business reason is explicit: people who have actually operated mines, logistics networks, recovery systems, industrial programs, software deployments and other consequential systems carry tacit knowledge that is unusually valuable in client work.

Internal recruiting remains subject to enterprise mobility and continuity doctrine. Advisory may recruit; it may not sabotage an operating line's continuity or bypass ordinary transition obligations.

2.3 Serving J2 personnel

Hands off.

Advisory may not recruit a serving J2 professional.

Prohibited conduct includes:

- direct solicitation;
- informal courtship;
- asking whether the person would be interested later;
- discussing a future Advisory title;
- discussing carry or expected economics;
- reserving a role;
- pre-clearing an application;
- allowing the person to begin the application process;
- using a third party to communicate interest;
- encouraging a manager or colleague to steer the person toward Advisory;
- shaping a J2 assignment to increase future Advisory value.

The rule applies to all serving J2 personnel, not only Orientation.

The purpose is not to make post-J2 careers difficult. It is to prevent J2 service from becoming a commercial audition.

3. Employee-initiated post-J2 entry

A former J2 professional may approach Advisory immediately after qualifying service is complete. There is no arbitrary cooling-off period.

The process must begin on the former J2 professional's initiative. Advisory may publish neutral information about career paths and eligibility rules, but it may not privately cultivate a serving individual.

No J2 manager, Orientation Officer, Judgment Officer, Contact leader, JAG participant or Education professional should need to wonder whether a judgment made in service will affect a promised Advisory role.

4. Carry

4.1 Definition

Sable Harbor uses the term **carry** deliberately.

Advisory carry is long-duration economic participation in the value of the Advisory business. It is conceptually analogous to carried interest in investment businesses: the participant shares in durable value creation beyond salary and annual bonus.

It is not ordinary salary, a guaranteed deferred bonus, an automatic profit share for every employee, or a reward for leaving J2.

4.2 Eligibility versus allocation

These are separate decisions.

Eligibility means a former J2 professional has completed the institutional-service gate required to be considered for carry.

Allocation means Advisory actually grants that person a defined economic interest under the carry plan.

A qualifying former J2 professional is not owed a carry percentage merely because eligibility exists.

4.3 Why carry is J2-restricted

The restriction is intended to recognize a specific institutional bargain:

- J2 service requires unusual professional discipline and, in Orientation, a permanent sacrifice of later line authority;
- J2 should be a prestigious career in its own right, not a feeder program;
- people who complete serious J2 service should have access to a later professional career with exceptional economic upside without needing to convert institutional access into corporate command;
- limiting carry to qualifying former J2 professionals gives the economic instrument a meaning distinct from ordinary Advisory compensation.

The restriction does **not** imply former J2 professionals are inherently better consultants than operating-line veterans or outside experts.

5. Carry gates

5.1 Orientation

A former commissioned Orientation Officer is carry-eligible after:

1. completing one full Orientation tour/commission; and
2. completing one qualifying fellowship.

This is the lowest additional Advisory gate because admission, formation and commission into Orientation already carry an unusually high institutional threshold.

Carry eligibility does not relax the permanent Orientation line-authority restriction.

5.2 Judgment

A former Judgment Officer is carry-eligible after:

1. at least five years in a Judgment Officer position; and
2. at least two years of substantive service in an actual Sable Harbor operating business line.

The operating service may occur before or after Judgment service unless later doctrine specifies sequencing.

JAG does not count as the operating-line requirement. JAG is a temporary field-tour institution, not an operating line and not a permanent Judgment role.

5.3 Contact

A former Contact professional is carry-eligible after at least four years in substantive Contact leadership.

Qualifying leadership requires genuine responsibility for people and collection outcomes. A title without corresponding accountability does not qualify.

Contact intentionally carries the highest threshold among the currently decided gates because it is a standing intelligence profession with less natural operating-line laterality and because leadership mastery is the clearest evidence that the candidate has progressed beyond technical collection skill alone.

5.4 Education and J2 Headquarters

OPEN . No gate is created by implication.

6. Orientation professional track in Advisory

Former Orientation Officers require a career path that can become economically exceptional without violating the anti-court bargain.

Advisory therefore separates **professional authority** from **line authority**.

A former Orientation Officer may hold senior professional titles and may:

- originate and lead professional matters;

- own professional judgment;
- serve as Matter Principal where compatible with the role's non-line design;
- review consequential matters;
- develop methodology;
- mentor professionals;
- hold carry;
- earn more than line executives.

The role may not become a disguised operating-VP office through control of headcount, enterprise operating budgets, business-line command or equivalent line decision rights prohibited by Orientation doctrine.

7. Management and professional leadership

Advisory should maintain two high-status ladders:

Management track

Owns:

- business-line P&L;
- workforce decisions;
- capacity;
- budget;
- enterprise commitments;
- operations of the Advisory business.

Professional track

Owns:

- client judgment;
- matter quality;
- professional craft;
- methods;
- review;
- reputation;
- mentorship;
- difficult client problem leadership.

The tracks may intersect but must not be collapsed into the assumption that the highest-paid person must be the person with the most line authority.

8. Compensation hierarchy

Advisory is intended to have the highest **upside ceiling** within Sable Harbor's professional careers.

That does not mean:

- every Advisory employee is paid more than every employee elsewhere;
- J2 is intentionally underpaid;
- operating-line experts are treated as second class;
- carry substitutes for fair cash compensation.

Operating-line veterans recruited into Advisory should be among the most highly compensated non-carry professionals because their tacit operating experience is a core differentiator.

9. Carry mechanics still open

The following require a later legal/finance plan and are not invented here:

- pool size;
- whether the instrument references Advisory profit, equity value, a phantom pool or another value base;
- grant units;
- vesting schedule;
- realization events;
- annual distributions;
- retirement treatment;
- good-leaver/bad-leaver rules;
- forfeiture;
- clawback;
- tax treatment;
- valuation method;
- dilution;
- governance rights, if any;
- treatment if Advisory becomes a separate legal entity.

Carry should confer economics, not automatic management or governance authority.

10. Anti-gaming controls

The carry system fails if people can optimize J2 careers around eligibility rather than institutional service.

Controls should therefore include:

- no Advisory recruiting while serving;
- no carry promise while serving;
- no accelerated J2 promotion for future Advisory value;
- qualifying service measured from substantive role completion, not nominal assignment dates;
- no title-only Contact leadership qualification;
- no JAG substitution for Judgment's operating-line requirement;
- no retroactive waiver invented for a commercially desirable candidate without an explicit owner-approved change to the rule.

11. Cultural test

A serving J2 professional should be able to believe all three statements simultaneously:

1. **I can have a complete, prestigious and well-paid career in J2.**
2. **If I finish this service and later want Advisory, that door can be economically extraordinary.**
3. **No decision I make in J2 today is part of an audition for that future.**

If the system stops making all three true, the boundary has failed.